



A Tiger in the Zoo



Summary

The poem shows two different lives of a tiger. In the zoo, the tiger is locked in a concrete cell. He walks quietly in anger and ignores visitors. His power is behind bars. At night he hears police cars and looks at stars, wanting freedom. In his natural home, he would be free. He would hide in grass near water, hunt deer, and walk around villages scaring people. The poet wants to say

wild animals should not be caged. They look beautiful and happy only in their natural jungle.

সাৰাংশ

কবিতাটোত এটা বাঘৰ দুটা ভিন্ন জীৱন দেখুওৱা হৈছে।
চিৰিয়াখানাত বাঘটোক পকী কোঠাত আবদ্ধ কৰি ৰখা হৈছে।
খঙত মনে মনে খোজ কাঢ়ে আৰু দৰ্শনাৰ্থীক আওকাণ কৰে।
তেওঁৰ ক্ষমতা কাৰাগাৰৰ আঁৰত। ৰাতি সি পুলিচৰ গাড়ী শুনি
তৰালৈ চাই থাকে, স্বাধীনতা বিচাৰি। নিজৰ প্ৰাকৃতিক ঘৰখনত
তেওঁ মুক্ত হ'ব। তেওঁ পানীৰ ওচৰত ঘাঁহনিত লুকাই আছিল,
হৰিণ চিকাৰ কৰিছিল আৰু মানুহক ভয় খুৱাই গাঁৱে-ভূঞা ঘূৰি
ফুৰিছিল। কবিয়ে কব বিচাৰিছে বনৰীয়া জীৱ-জন্তুক পিঞ্জৰাত
ভৰোৱা উচিত নহয়। কেৱল নিজৰ প্ৰাকৃতিক জংঘলতহে ধুনীয়া
আৰু সুখী দেখা যায়।

A Tiger in the Zoo – 6 Important Word Meanings

1. **Stalks** – walks slowly and proudly
2. **Vivid** – bright and clear
3. **Lurking** – hiding and waiting
4. **Snarling** – showing teeth in anger
5. **Baring** – showing
6. **Patrolling** – going around to guard

□□□□ A Tiger in the Zoo – 6 Important Q & A □□□□

1. How does the tiger walk in cage?

Ans: He stalks slowly in his small cage in quiet rage.

2. How should tiger be in jungle?

Ans: He should lurk in shadow, sliding through grass near water to hunt deer.

3. Why does he snarl at village edge?

Ans: To show his fangs and claws and scare villagers.

4. How is caged tiger described?

Ans: Locked in concrete cell, strength behind bars, ignoring visitors.

5. What does tiger do at night?

Ans: He hears patrolling cars and looks at stars with bright eyes, dreaming of freedom.

6. What is message of poem?

Ans: Wild animals are not happy in zoo. They should be free in natural habitat.



Thinking about the Poem



(1) Find the words that describe the movements and actions of the tiger in the cage and in the wild. Arrange them into two columns.

Ans:

In the cage | In the wild

Stalks in quiet rage | Lurking in shadow

Few steps | Sliding through long grass

Ignoring visitors | Snarling around houses

Locked, hears, stares at stars | Baring fangs and claws

(ii) Find the words that describe the two places, and arrange them in two columns.

Now try to share ideas about how the poet uses words and images to contrast the two situations.

Ans:

Cage (Zoo) | Wild (Jungle)

Concrete cell | Shadow

Small cage | Long grass

Behind bars | Water hole

Concrete cell | Jungle's edge

Patrolling cars | Village

How poet contrasts:

Poet uses dark, limiting words for zoo like concrete, cell, bars, few steps, quiet rage to show helplessness and anger. For wild he uses energetic, powerful words like lurking, sliding, snarling, baring to show freedom and power.

Images of locked cell vs open jungle make us feel that tiger belongs in jungle, not in zoo.

2. Notice the use of a word repeated in lines such as these:

(1) On pads of velvet quiet. In his quiet rage..

The effect of repetition:

Ans:

quiet – quiet : In line "pads of velvet quiet. In his quiet rage" the word quiet is repeated to show contrast. Pads are soft and quiet but inside the tiger has intense, suppressed anger. Repetition makes the anger feel deeper and more controlled.

(ii) And stares with his brilliant eyes At the brilliant stars.

Ans:

brilliant – brilliant : In "brilliant eyes At the brilliant stars" repetition connects the tiger and the stars. Both are brilliant, beautiful and far away from each other. It shows tiger's dream for freedom is as brilliant and distant as the stars. It also creates musical effect and emphasis.

Overall, repetition makes the poem more effective and highlights the contrast between cage and freedom.

3. Are zoos necessary for the protection or conservation of some species of animals? Are they useful for educating the public? Are there alternatives to zoos?

This is a discussion question – you can write this in your own words:

Ans:

Zoos are necessary to some extent for protection and conservation. For endangered species like

tigers, panthers, one-horned rhinos, zoos provide safety, food, and breeding programs when their natural habitat is destroyed by deforestation and poaching. They save species from extinction.

They are useful for educating public because people, especially children, can see wild animals closely which they cannot see in forests. It creates awareness and love for animals.

But zoos have many problems. Animals are kept in small artificial cages, they lose freedom and natural behaviour, like the tiger in the poem who stalks in quiet rage. So zoos can be cruel.

Alternatives to zoos are:

1. Wildlife Sanctuaries and National Parks – Kaziranga, Jim Corbett where animals live free.

2. Biosphere Reserves – large protected natural habitats.

3. Safari Parks and Open Reserves – animals in open area, visitors in cages/vehicles.

4. Virtual zoos, documentaries and AR/VR for education without caging animals.

Best way is to protect natural habitat so animals don't need zoos.
